their final decision. At that moment, someone in the room said that the Americans, who until now had been out of the loop, ought to be informed. The king and Rabin decided to update President Clinton directly and asked to contact the White House. When the president got on the line, they told him that they had just shaken hands, signaling that the peace agreement had been finalized.

From there things moved quickly. It was agreed that a meeting would be held in Washington, which would continue with the signing ceremony in Ein Evrona near Eilat and Aqaba and an official public visit by Foreign Minister Peres to Jordan. The rest is history. On a personal note, I would like to mention that around midnight, the day after the ceremony in Washington, I received a call at home from the king's plane. He was on his flight back to Amman and was dropping Efraim off on the way. The king wished to thank me personally for my role in achieving peace. It was a gracious gesture on the part of the king that I will always remember.

The operation of achieving a peace treaty with Jordan succeeded. The secret of its success lay in the presence of two essential conditions. One was the long history of the Mossad's secret ties with the Jordanian royal family, including the personal chemistry between Efraim Halevy and the king and Prince Hassan. The other was the close personal involvement of the leaders, Yitzhak Rabin and King Hussein, in the negotiation process, including the chemistry that formed between them and their willingness to solve in real time any problem that the negotiating teams could not resolve on their own.

King Hussein viewed the continued survival of the Hashemite Kingdom as his primary goal. He saw several factors as necessary in ensuring this survival, including:

- Good relations with Israel: Hussein regarded Israel as a strategic pillar, with an interest in the continued survival of his kingdom; this was a necessary, though in his eyes not a sufficient, condition for its survival.
- Strategic ties with at least one other Arab country. Hussein understood that Jordan must have at least one major Arab country from the Middle East as its ally—Syria, Saudi Arabia, Iraq, or Egypt.
- A guarantee of support from the United States.

An understanding of these considerations seems necessary in order to understand developments in the Middle East and the steps taken by Jordan